

CASE ID: 201001710002

EPISODE NAME: US Taiwan Arms Sales 2010

2010/01/30 - 2011/01/10

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: End Weapons/Materials Proliferation (9)

Final Outcome: Stalemate in the Threat Stage (4)

Summary:

On 2010/01/30, China issued strong yet vague threats of commercial sanctions against United States arms manufacturers and announced the cancellation of some military exchange programs in response to US weapons sales to Taiwan. These sanctions were never imposed, however diplomatic sanctions were imposed. Military-to-military exchanges were restored on 2011/01/10.

Narrative:

On 2010/01/30, China threatened commercial sanctions against United States arms manufacturers and announced the cancellation of some military exchange programs in response to US weapons sales to Taiwan, which China claimed was a violation of its “one China” policy.¹

The conflict was initiated on 2010/01/29, when President Barack Obama announced \$6.4 billion in arms sales to Taiwan.² On 2010/01/30, the Chinese Foreign Ministry threatened vague but strongly committed commercial import restrictions that did not specify which military arms companies would be affected or what measures would be taken, but was clear that it wanted military arms sales to stop.³

The costs for China and the US were predicted to be large, considering China relies on US manufacturing for their growing commercial airline fleet.⁴ The amount to be lost by both China and the US, if China imposed sanctions on Boeing – likely, considering they were one of the firms selling arms to Taiwan – was predicted to be valued at \$400 billion USD.⁵ These commercial sanctions were never imposed, however on 2010/01/30, the Chinese Foreign Ministry announced diplomatic

¹ Bradsher, Keith. “U.S. Deal with Taiwan Has China Retaliating.” *The New York Times*, January 30th, 2010. www.nytimes.com/2010/01/31/world/asia/31china.html.

² Nasaw, Daniel, and Batty, David. “China Retaliates over US Arms Sales to Taiwan.” *The Guardian*, January 30th, 2010. www.theguardian.com/world/2010/jan/30/china-sanctions-taiwan-arms-sales.

³ Bradsher, Keith. “U.S. Deal with Taiwan Has China Retaliating.” *The New York Times*, January 30th, 2010. www.nytimes.com/2010/01/31/world/asia/31china.html.

⁴ Ide, Bill. “Analysts: Effect of Possible Chinese Sanctions against US Companies Would Be ‘Limited.’” *Voice of America*, January 31st, 2010. <https://www.voanews.com/a/analysts-effect-of-possible-chinese-sanctions-against-us-companies-would-be-limited-83303747/165340.html>.

⁵Ibid.

sanctions ending military exchange programs.⁶

The episode ended on 2011/01/10 when military-to-military exchanges were restored during a state visit by then-Secretary of Defense Robert Gates to China.⁷ In the following years, the US continued to send arms to Taiwan.⁸

⁶ Bradsher, Keith. "U.S. Deal with Taiwan Has China Retaliating." *The New York Times*, January 30th, 2010. www.nytimes.com/2010/01/31/world/asia/31china.html.

⁷ "US-China move to mend military ties." *Al Jazeera*, January 10th, 2011. <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2011/1/10/us-china-move-to-mend-military-ties#:~:text=Defence%20chiefs%20make%20first%20strategy,vital%20way%20to%20resolve%20disputes>.

⁸ Rogin, Josh. "Is the Obama Administration Prepping Another Arms Sale to Taiwan?" *Foreign Policy*, January 13th, 2011. foreignpolicy.com/2011/01/13/is-the-obama-administration-prepping-another-arms-sale-to-taiwan/.